making so much headway with this that we had to defuse it or else lose the election.

"I've got a suggestion," I said. "From now on, why don't I just say a few words to whatever group I'm with, no matter how big it is, and then just open it up to questions and answers? People might think somebody had written my opening remarks for me, but they'll know it would be impossible for somebody to feed me answers to questions I didn't know about in advance."

The political professionals in our group blanched when I said that.

They were used to hiding candidates, not turning them loose. I think the idea of a candidate being on his own scared them. *Do you really want to do that?* they asked.

"I think I *have* to do it," I said.

Well, it worked like a charm. From then on, whether the campaign audience was three or three thousand, I'd make a few remarks, then take questions. I hadn't planned it that way, but this turned out to be a wonderful way to learn about the issues that were on people's minds.

At the time, the public universities in California were going up in smoke; rioting students were literally setting fire to them.

Californians were rightfully proud of and dedicated to their great system of higher education—especially the nine campuses of the University of California—and they were upset by what was going on.

After I started the new question-and-answer style of campaigning, I'd make a few introductory remarks and ask for questions and no matter where I was, before I could finish, there'd be people waving their hands and asking: "What are you going to do about these things going on on the college campuses?"

I had to come up with some answers.